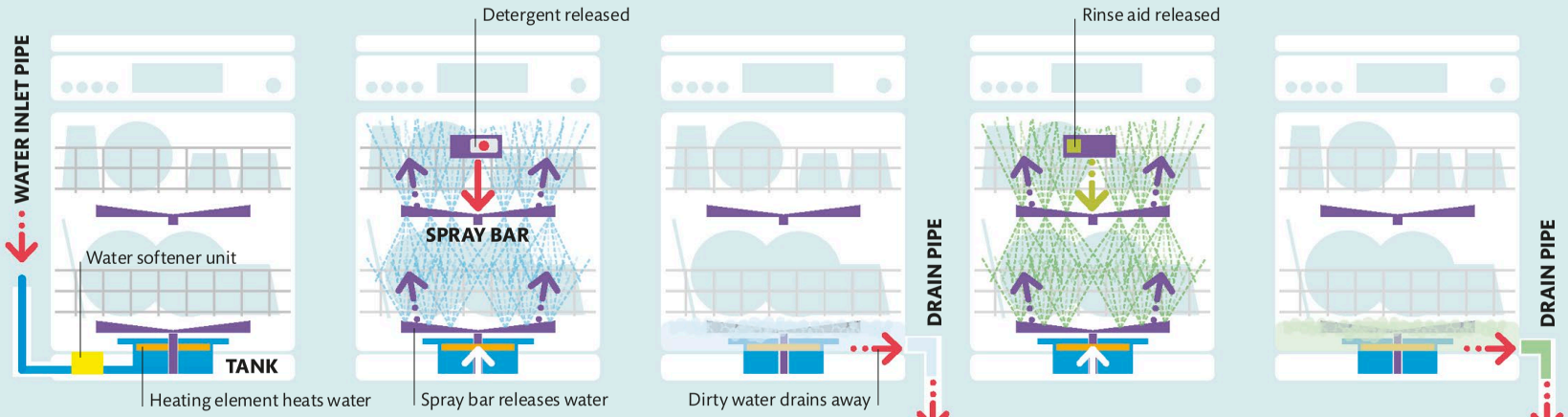


1 Water in and heated
A pump draws water from the water supply, usually through a water softener unit. An electric element in the base heats the water.

2 Rinse with detergent
As water is pumped through the spray bars, detergent is released. Pressure causes the bars to spin and spray water out in all directions.

3 Wash and drain
Hot water and detergent are repeatedly pumped through the spray bars to clean the load. The cycle ends with dirty water draining away.

4 Rinse with hot water
Clean water is pumped in and mixed with rinse aid, which lowers surface tension so that water runs off quickly without streaking cleaned objects.

5 Final rinse and drain
A final rinse with clean water is an option with some dishwasher programs. The water is drained, and heat inside the machine assists drying.

Dishwashers

A dishwasher combines pumps, electric heating elements, high-pressure water sprays, and cleaning chemicals—all coordinated by a microprocessor—to wash, rinse, and dry kitchenware in a sequence of stages.

How a dishwasher works

Dishwashers heat and apply water under pressure to dirty dishes, cutlery, and kitchenware held in baskets and racks. Small, powerful jets of spray combined with dissolved detergent dislodge debris and stains. The cleaning process is aided by the high temperature of the water, which helps cut through grease and fatty deposits. To finish, a load is rinsed with water and rinse aid and then, in some machines, dried using heated air.

